

Muzhi Liu

Department of Political Science
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Political Science, Columbia University expected May 2028
Concurrent M.A. in Statistics, Columbia University expected May 2027
Ph.D. coursework in the Departments of Mathematics and Statistics (2026–27): Analysis and Probability I, Analysis II, Probability II; Theoretical Statistics I–II; Probabilistic Models and Machine Learning.
Additional coursework: Causal Inference, Field Experiments, Bayesian Statistics, Stochastic Processes, Game Theory, Optimization, Differential Equations.
B.A. in Political Science, *magna cum laude*, Emory University, Atlanta, GA May 2023

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political Methodology; Political Behavior; Public Opinion; Political Economy

METHODS AND SKILLS

Causal inference; Experiments; Text-as-data/NLP; Machine Learning; LLM-assisted measurement; Mathematical modeling and analysis

Tools: R, Python, Stan, L^AT_EX, Git, SQL, Qualtrics, CloudResearch, Prolific

REVISE AND RESUBMIT

1. “Demobilization Without Backlash: Campaign Donations and the DOGE Workforce Reduction.” [*Revise and resubmit at **Political Behavior***]
2. “When Group Issues and Core Issues Collide: Evidence from Tailored Conjoint Experiments on Latino Voters” (with Yamil Velez). [*Revise and resubmit at **Political Behavior***]

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

1. “Borrowed Battlegrounds: When U.S. Political Violence Becomes Partisan News Abroad—Evidence from Five Language Communities on X (2024–2025).” [*Submitted*]
2. “Estimand-First Comparative Text Analysis: Measuring Discourse Change Across Co-Exposed Platforms.” [*Under review*]
3. “Democracy Out of Sync: Circadian Misalignment and the Cost of Voting” (with Xuan Li). [*Submitted*]

ONGOING PROJECTS

1. “Claiming Corporate Success: Economic Exposure and Support for the Incumbent Party.” [*Draft in Progress*]
2. “Buying American Abroad: Political Identity and Consumer Choice” (with Donald P. Green).
3. “Primary Election and Intra-Party Factions” (with Shigeo Hirano and Sam Frederick).

GRANTS AND AWARDS

IHS Mentorship Grant, Institute for Humane Studies (\$8,000) Summer 2026
American Political Science Association, Spring Centennial Research Grant (\$2,500) Spring 2026
Columbia Experimental Laboratory for Social Sciences Student Seed Grant (\$1,000) Fall 2025
First Place, Young Public Opinion Scholar Competition, NY/PA–NJ AAPOR (\$1,000) Summer 2025

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (APSA) Sep. 2026
Li, X.; **Liu, M.** “Democracy Out of Sync: Circadian Misalignment and the Cost of Voting.”
Liu, M. “Borrowed Battlegrounds: When U.S. Political Violence Becomes Partisan News Abroad—Evidence from Five Language Communities on X (2024–2025).”

	Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior Conference	May 2026
	Li, X.; Liu, M. “Democracy Out of Sync: Circadian Misalignment and the Cost of Voting.”	
	Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference (MPSA)	Apr. 2026
	Liu, M. “Electoral Spectators: The 2024 U.S. Presidential Election and Online Political Discourse in China.”	
	American Association for Public Opinion Research Annual Conference (AAPOR)	May 2025
	Velez, Y.; Liu, M. “In Their Own Words: A Tailored Approach to Measuring Politicized Group Attachments.”	
SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS	Political Science Graduate Student Seminar, Columbia University	Mar. 2026 Sep. 2026
	Columbia–NYU Graduate Student Seminar in Political Science	Apr. 2026
	American Politics Graduate Student Seminar, Columbia University	Mar. 2025 Oct. 2025 Mar. 2026 Oct. 2025
	Comparative Politics Seminar, Columbia University	Oct. 2025
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Teaching Assistant, Columbia University	2024–2026
	<i>Graduate courses:</i> Quantitative Methods IV: Advanced Statistical Modeling (Spring 2026); Quantitative Methods III: Field Experiments (Fall 2025); Math and Statistics in Political Science (Spring 2024).	
	<i>Undergraduate courses:</i> Experiments (Fall 2026); Introduction to American Politics and Government (Summer 2024; Spring 2025).	
RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Research Assistant, Columbia University	2023–2024
	<i>Supervisors: Robert Shapiro and Alan Yang.</i> Public opinion and polarization projects; cleaned and merged survey datasets; implemented regression and robustness pipelines in R; produced publication-ready figures and tables.	
	Research Assistant, Emory University	2021–2023
	<i>Supervisors: Kiela Crabtree, Zachary Peskowitz, and Kevin Sparrow.</i> Research on political violence and minority politics; assembled datasets from public sources; conducted literature synthesis; supported survey/conjoint design and analysis; prepared replication-ready code and documentation.	
ACADEMIC SERVICE	Editorial Assistant, <i>Political Science Quarterly</i>	Mar. 2024–Spring 2026
	Linkage Chair, Political Science Graduate Student Council, Columbia University	Jun. 2024–May 2025
	Member, Student Advisory Board, Emory University	Sep. 2021–May 2023
PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	Community Engagement Intern, International Rescue Committee, Atlanta, GA	Jun. 2023–Sep. 2023
	Academic Consultant and Instructor, Yuan Foundation, Washington, DC	May 2023–Aug. 2023
	Research Assistant, Ashoka, Remote	Jan. 2023–Apr. 2023